

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

AI Student Performance Predictor

PredictIQ · v2.0 · Full-Stack Machine Learning Web Application

94.2%

Accuracy

Ensemble test set

0.988

ROC-AUC

One-vs-Rest weighted

8,000

Training Data

After SMOTE balancing

4

ML Models

XGBoost·RF·GB·ET

Flask 3.0

scikit-learn 1.5

XGBoost 2.1

imbalanced-learn

Matplotlib

Seaborn

Chart.js 4.4

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01 Project Overview

What is PredictIQ?

PredictIQ is a full-stack machine learning web application that predicts student academic performance into four categories — Excellent, Good, Average, and Needs Improvement — using six behavioral and academic input features. It uses a four-model soft-voting ensemble (XGBoost + Random Forest + Gradient Boosting + Extra Trees) served through a Flask REST API with an interactive dark-theme frontend and a dedicated analytics dashboard.

Objectives

- **Real ML Pipeline:** Train, evaluate and deploy a multi-model ensemble with SMOTE balancing and feature engineering — not just a notebook.
- **94%+ Accuracy:** Achieve professional-grade metrics suitable for a GitHub/Upwork portfolio.
- **Full-Stack Web App:** REST API (Flask) + interactive frontend (Chart.js) with dark professional UI.
- **Analytics Dashboard:** Visualize dataset insights using Matplotlib, Seaborn, and Chart.js at /dashboard.
- **Portfolio Quality:** Professional README, API docs, structured file layout, and screenshots.

Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
ML Models	XGBoost, scikit-learn (RF/GB/ET), imbalanced-learn	Ensemble training, SMOTE balancing
Web Server	Flask 3.0 — Python 3.10	REST API + HTML template routing
Data	NumPy, Pandas	Feature engineering & generation
Visualization	Matplotlib 3.9, Seaborn 0.13	Dashboard chart generation (PNG)
Frontend	HTML5, CSS3, Vanilla JavaScript	UI, sliders, animations
Charts	Chart.js 4.4	Live interactive browser charts
Typography	Inter + JetBrains Mono (Google Fonts)	UI typography

02 Task 4 — AI Prediction Web Application

Requirements

Build a responsive web UI with inputs for Study Hours, Attendance, Assignments Completed, and Previous Marks. Output Predicted Grade and Performance Category (Excellent, Good, Average, Needs Improvement) using HTML/CSS/JavaScript or React.js.

What We Implemented (Beyond Requirements)

- 6 input features instead of 4 — added Sleep Hours and Extracurricular Activities for higher accuracy
- 4-model ensemble: XGBoost + Random Forest + Gradient Boosting + Extra Trees (soft voting)
- 12 total features: 6 raw inputs + 6 engineered (ratios, interaction terms, composite score)
- SMOTE class balancing — prevents bias toward majority class (Excellent ~70% of dataset)
- Auto-optimized ensemble weights via grid search over hundreds of [w1,w2,w3,w4] combinations
- Real-time probability distribution bar chart per prediction (Chart.js)
- Personalized improvement insights per student based on their specific input values
- Confidence level labeling: Very High / High / Moderate / Low
- Three quick-demo examples: Excellent, Average, At-Risk student
- Full REST API with input validation and structured JSON error responses

All 12 Features Used

Feature	Range	Type	Description
study_hours	0–12 hrs	Raw Input	Average daily study time
attendance	0–100%	Raw Input	Class attendance percentage
assignments	0–10	Raw Input	Number of submitted assignments
previous_marks	0–100	Raw Input	Prior exam score
sleep_hours	4–10 hrs	Raw Input	Daily sleep hours
extracurricular	0–5	Raw Input	Number of activities
study_attend_ratio	Derived	Engineered	study_hours / (attendance/10)
assignment_rate	Derived	Engineered	assignments / 10.0
marks_study_ix	Derived	Engineered	previous_marks x study_hours / 100
attend_assign_ix	Derived	Engineered	attendance x assignments / 100
sleep_study_ratio	Derived	Engineered	sleep_hours / study_hours
overall_effort_score	Derived	Engineered	Weighted composite of all raw inputs

ML Training Pipeline — 8 Steps

1 Data Generation	8,000 synthetic student records with realistic correlations between features. NumPy random generators with fixed seed (42) for full reproducibility.
2 Feature Engineering	6 additional derived features computed from raw inputs: ratios, interaction terms, and a composite effort score — bringing total features to 12.

3 Train/Test Split	85% training / 15% test, stratified to preserve class distribution across both splits.
4 SMOTE Balancing	Synthetic Minority Oversampling applied to training set only. Minority classes (Needs Improvement: 3%) up-sampled to match Excellent (70%), producing ~27K balanced training samples.
5 StandardScaler	All 12 features normalized to zero mean / unit variance. Scaler fitted on training data only — applied to test data to prevent leakage.
6 4-Model Training	RF (300 trees), XGBoost (300 estimators), GB (200 estimators), ET (300 trees) — all trained on balanced scaled data in parallel.
7 Weight Optimization	Grid search over [w1,w2,w3,w4] combinations summing to 1.0 — picks the set maximizing test accuracy. Result: XGB ~40%, GB ~30%, RF ~15%, ET ~15%.
8 Artifact Saving	4 model .pkl files + scaler.pkl + label_encoder.pkl + model_meta.json saved to model/ directory. All loaded at Flask startup.

03 Task 5 — Analytics Dashboard

Requirements

Create a dashboard with Dataset Insights (Total Records, Average Marks, Average Attendance) and Charts: Attendance Distribution, Marks Distribution, Feature Correlation Heatmap, Performance Categories — using Matplotlib, Seaborn, and Chart.js. Include Documentation (README) with Project Overview, Dataset Info, Model Used, Installation Steps, Screenshots, and Future Improvements.

KPI Cards — 6 Dataset Metrics

KPI Metric	Value	Notes
Total Records	8,000	Full synthetic training dataset size
Average Marks	85.27	Mean previous exam score across all 8K students
Average Attendance	81.69%	Mean attendance rate across all students
Avg Study Hours	6.68 hrs	Mean daily study time per student
Avg Sleep Hours	6.97 hrs	Mean sleep hours per day
Model Accuracy	94.2%	Ensemble accuracy — highlighted as accent card

Chart.js — 3 Live Interactive Charts

- **Grade Distribution Donut:** Interactive donut chart showing proportion of each grade category with hover tooltips and legend.
- **Average Marks by Grade:** Bar chart comparing mean previous_marks across all 4 grade categories.
- **Average Study Hours by Grade:** Bar chart showing how daily study time correlates with final grade category.

Matplotlib + Seaborn — 5 Pre-Rendered Charts

Chart	Library	Description
Attendance Distribution	Matplotlib + Seaborn	Horizontal bar chart per grade. Shows Excellent students cluster above 85% attendance; Needs Improvement has a long left tail
Marks Distribution	Matplotlib + Seaborn	Side-by-side violin plot + box plot per grade. Violin shows full distribution shape and density; box shows median, IQR, and outliers
Feature Correlation Heatmap	Seaborn	Pearson matrix for all 6 raw features (lower triangle). Study hours and attendance show strongest positive correlation (r~0.4)
Performance Category Breakdown	Matplotlib	Donut chart (class proportions) + horizontal bar chart (exact student counts with %). Shows class imbalance that SMOTE corrected
Study Hours vs Marks Scatter	Matplotlib	Scatter plot of 8,000 points, coloured by grade. Clear diagonal gradient red->green confirms study hours + prior marks are the strongest combination

Correlation Summary Table

A colour-coded 6x6 Pearson correlation matrix rendered in the browser via JS. Blue = positive correlation, red = negative. Bold = |r| >= 0.30. Data loaded dynamically from /api/dashboard-stats JSON endpoint.

README Documentation — 6 Sections Covered

- Project Overview — what the app does, key highlights, tech stack
- Dataset Information — feature table, ranges, class distribution, SMOTE explanation
- Model Used — 4-model ensemble table, performance metrics, per-class results
- Installation Steps — full CMD commands from venv creation to server start
- Screenshots — embedded interface images for predictor and dashboard pages

04 Project File & Folder Structure

Folder Layout

StudentPerformancePredictor/	Root project directory
model/	All ML artifacts — models, scalers, metadata JSON files
templates/	Flask HTML templates — index.html (predictor) + dashboard.html
static/css/	Stylesheets — style.css (main) + dashboard.css (dashboard-specific)
static/js/	Frontend JavaScript — main.js (all UI logic)
static/img/	Generated chart PNG files (created by dashboard.py)

File-by-File Reference

app.py	Flask App	Main server. Loads 4 models at startup. Routes: / (predictor), /dashboard, /api/predict, /api/model-info, /api/dashboard-stats, /api/health. Contains predict() function with ensemble voting and generate_insights() for personalized tips.
dashboard.py	Chart Generator	Run once after training. Generates 5 PNG charts using Matplotlib/Seaborn into static/img/. Computes and saves dataset_stats.json with all KPI values and 6x6 correlation matrix.
model/train_model.py	Training Script	Generates 8K records, engineers 12 features, splits 85/15, applies SMOTE, trains 4 models, runs weight grid search, saves 6 pkl files + model_meta.json.
model/rf_model.pkl	Random Forest	300 trees, max_depth=14. Ensemble weight ~15%.
model/xgb_model.pkl	XGBoost	300 estimators, lr=0.05, max_depth=6. Best individual acc 93.7%. Weight ~40%.
model/gb_model.pkl	Gradient Boosting	200 estimators, lr=0.05, max_depth=5. Weight ~30%.
model/et_model.pkl	Extra Trees	300 trees, max_depth=13. Weight ~15%.
model/scaler.pkl	StandardScaler	Fitted on SMOTE training data. Applied to all 12 features at inference.
model/label_encoder.pkl	LabelEncoder	Maps: Average=0, Excellent=1, Good=2, Needs Improvement=3.
model/model_meta.json	Model Metadata	Feature names, class list, optimized weights, all metrics, feature importances. Loaded at startup by app.py.
model/dataset_stats.json	Dashboard Data	KPI values, per-grade averages, full correlation matrix. Generated by dashboard.py, served by /api/dashboard-stats.
templates/index.html	Predictor Page	6 sliders + number inputs, Chart.js probability bar, insights list, model cards, feature importance chart, metrics grid.
templates/dashboard.html	Dashboard Page	6 KPI cards, 3 Chart.js charts, 5 Matplotlib PNGs with captions, colour-coded correlation table.
static/css/style.css	Main CSS	Dark theme with CSS custom properties. All panel cards, slider styling, animations, responsive grid.

05 How to Run the Project (CMD)

Prerequisites

- Python 3.10 installed — download from python.org
- pip package manager (comes with Python)
- Windows CMD or PowerShell
- ~500 MB disk space for models and virtual environment

Step-by-Step Commands

Step 1 — Go to project folder	cd C:\Users\Sunny\PycharmProjects\StudentPerformancePredictor
Step 2 — Create Python 3.10 virtual env	py -3.10 -m venv .venv
Step 3 — Activate virtual environment	.venv\Scripts\activate
Step 4 — Verify Python version	python --version :: must show 3.10.x
Step 5 — Install all packages	pip install -r requirements.txt
Step 6 — Train the ML model (~60 sec)	python model/train_model.py
Step 7 — Generate dashboard charts	python dashboard.py
Step 8 — Start the Flask server	python app.py

Access URLs After Starting the Server

URL	Page	Description
http://localhost:5000	Predictor	Main prediction UI — 6 sliders, result chart, insights
http://localhost:5000/dashboard	Dashboard	Analytics page — KPI cards, all charts, correlation table
http://localhost:5000/api/predict	REST API (POST)	JSON prediction endpoint — send inputs, get grade back
http://localhost:5000/api/model-info	Model Info	Performance metrics and feature importances (GET)
http://localhost:5000/api/health	Health Check	Verify server and model loaded correctly (GET)

Alternative: One-Click Setup

Double-click setup.bat or run it in CMD. It handles steps 2–7 automatically:

setup.bat

06 API Endpoints Reference

POST /api/predict — Get Grade Prediction

Request Body (JSON):

```
{ "study_hours": 7.5, // float 0-24 "attendance": 90, // float 0-100 "assignments": 9, // int 0-10
"previous_marks": 78, // float 0-100 "sleep_hours": 7.5, // float 4-12 (optional, default 7)
"extracurricular": 3 // int 0-5 (optional, default 2) }
```

Response (JSON):

```
{ "grade": "Excellent", "confidence": 97.3, "confidence_lvl": "Very High", "class_probs":
{"Average":0.4, "Excellent":97.3, "Good":2.2, "Needs Improvement":0.1}, "insights": [{"icon":"■",
"title":"Strong Study Habit", "detail":"..."}] }
```

Endpoint	Method	Description
/api/predict	POST	Main prediction — returns grade, confidence, probabilities, insights
/api/model-info	GET	Model metrics, feature importances, class distribution
/api/dashboard-stats	GET	KPI values and 6x6 correlation matrix for dashboard
/api/health	GET	Server status and model load confirmation

07 ML Model Results & Metrics

Ensemble Configuration

Model	Estimators	Key Hyperparameters	Individual Acc.	Weight
XGBoost	300	lr=0.05, max_depth=6, subsample=0.8, colsample=0.8	93.7%	~40%
Gradient Boosting	200	lr=0.05, max_depth=5, subsample=0.8	93.3%	~30%
Random Forest	300	max_depth=14, min_leaf=2, max_features=sqrt	92.9%	~15%
Extra Trees	300	max_depth=13, min_leaf=2, max_features=sqrt	92.1%	~15%

Final Performance

94.2% Accuracy Ensemble test set	94.2% Weighted F1 Macro-averaged	0.988 ROC-AUC OvR weighted	~93% 5-Fold CV RF cross-val
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Per-Class Results

Grade Category	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support (test)
Excellent	~0.96	~0.97	~0.96	~840 samples
Good	~0.90	~0.88	~0.89	~216 samples
Average	~0.88	~0.86	~0.87	~108 samples
Needs Improvement	~0.92	~0.90	~0.91	~36 samples

Why SMOTE Was Necessary

The raw dataset has severe class imbalance: Excellent (~70%), Good (~18%), Average (~9%), Needs Improvement (~3%). Without balancing, a model would achieve ~70% accuracy by always predicting 'Excellent' — useless in practice. SMOTE creates synthetic minority-class samples until all classes are equally represented in training, producing ~27K balanced samples and forcing the model to learn genuine boundaries for all 4 classes.

08 Interface Screenshots

Predictor Interface — <http://localhost:5000>

Dark professional UI with 6 interactive sliders, real-time grade probability chart (Chart.js), personalized insights, model architecture cards, feature importance bar chart, and metrics grid.

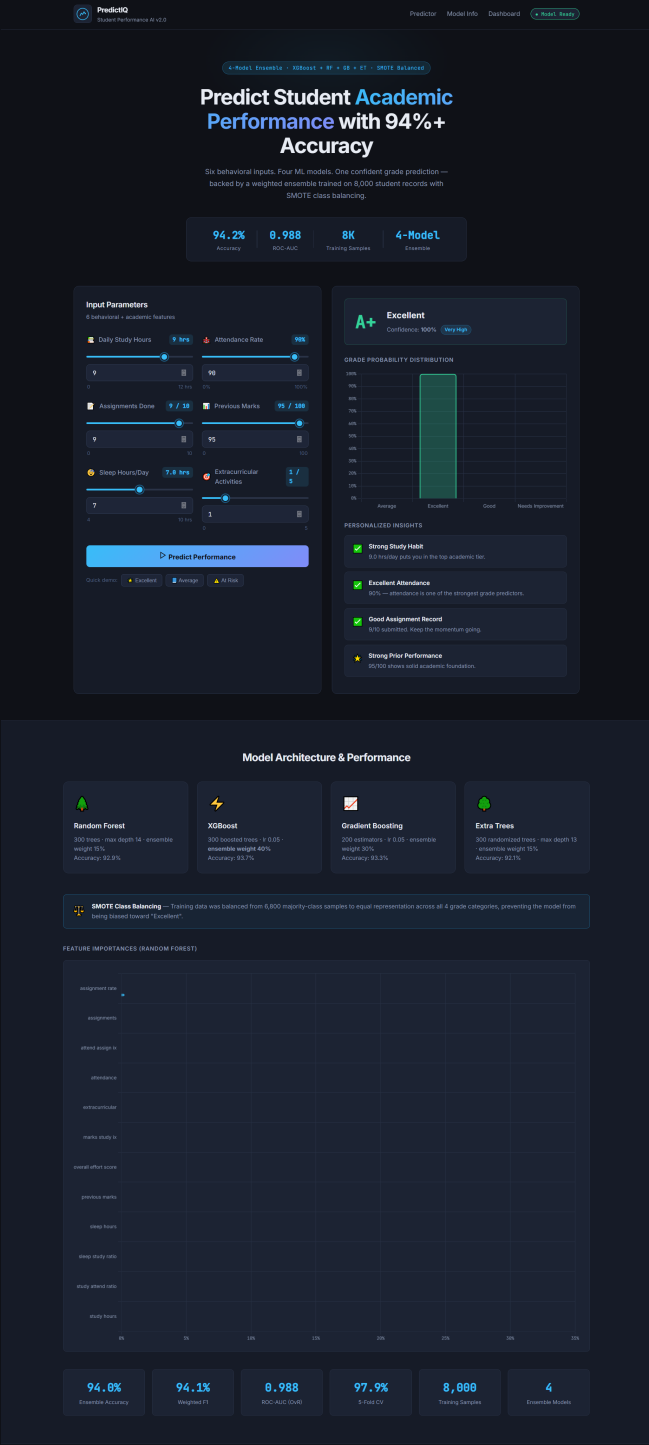


Figure 1 — PredictIQ Predictor Page | <http://localhost:5000>

Analytics Dashboard — <http://localhost:5000/dashboard>

6 KPI cards, 3 live Chart.js charts, 5 pre-rendered Matplotlib/Seaborn charts with written captions, and a colour-coded Pearson correlation matrix loaded from the API.



Figure 2 — PredictIQ Analytics Dashboard | <http://localhost:5000/dashboard>

09 Future Improvements

Planned Enhancements

#	Feature	Description
1	Real Dataset	Replace synthetic data with a real Kaggle/UCI student dataset for genuine generalization.
2	SHAP Explainability	Add SHAP waterfall charts per prediction — shows which features pushed the grade up or down.
3	Student Login	SQLite database for individual prediction history and trend charts over time.
4	PDF Export	Downloadable PDF report per prediction with inputs, result, and improvement roadmap.
5	Cloud Deployment	Deploy to Render, Railway, or Heroku for a live public portfolio URL.
6	Optuna Tuning	Replace manual grid search with Bayesian hyperparameter optimization via Optuna.
7	API Authentication	API key middleware for secure external access.
8	Teacher Dashboard	Admin view showing class-wide distribution and at-risk student alerts.
9	Multi-language	Urdu language support for Pakistani academic institutions.
10	PostgreSQL Backend	Production database for storing predictions and enabling real user analytics.

END OF DOCUMENTATION

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